WOOD SLICE WALL CLOCK

Step-by-Step DIY Guide

Craft a Stunning Live-Edge Clock with Epoxy Resin & Gold Hardware

The finished wood slice wall clock — natural grain, black epoxy border, and gold hands glowing in morning light

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About This Project

This wall clock is one of the most striking pieces you can make by hand. A natural wood slice — with all its rings, cracks, and character — becomes the clock face. Dark epoxy resin is poured around the wood and into its natural cracks, creating a dramatic glossy border that contrasts beautifully with the warm grain. Gold clock hands and subtle hour markers complete the look. The result is a functional piece of wall art that sells for $150–400 in boutiques — made for a fraction of the cost.

Difficulty	Intermediate (epoxy requires care and patience)
Active time	2–3 hours (spread over 2 days)
Epoxy cure time	24–48 hours before demolding; full cure 7 days
Finished size	30–40 cm diameter (depends on wood slice size)
Cost estimate	$30–60 USD (depending on epoxy and wood source)
Best for	Premium home decor, gifts, craft markets, Etsy
Retail value	$150–400 USD equivalent in boutiques

Materials & Tools

#	Item	Notes
1	Wood slice (live edge)	30–40 cm diameter, 2–4 cm thick. Dry, seasoned wood only — green/wet wood will r
2	Epoxy resin (table-top grade)	A clear, self-levelling two-part epoxy designed for casting. Choose a UV-stable formu
3	Epoxy pigment / alcohol ink	Black pigment creates the dramatic dark border shown in the video. Deep black or eb
4	Round silicone mold	Slightly larger than your wood slice — the gap between wood and mold creates the r
5	Clock movement mechanism	A standard quartz clock movement with a shaft length matching your wood/resin thick
6	Gold clock hands set	Hour, minute, and second hands in gold. Choose a style that matches your aesthetic
7	Gold hour markers (brass rods)	Small brass tubes or rods (~4–5 cm long, 3–4 mm diameter) embedded in the resin b
8	Drill + 8–10 mm drill bit	To drill the central hole for the clock shaft. If the wood slice doesn't have a natural ho
9	Mixing cups + stir sticks	Disposable plastic cups for measuring and mixing resin. Always mix in a 1:1 or per m
10	Heat gun or butane torch	To pop surface bubbles in the epoxy after pouring — essential for a glass-smooth fin
11	Nitrile gloves + safety glasses	Always wear PPE when working with epoxy resin — uncured resin is a skin sensitise
12	Sandpaper (120–400 grit)	For sanding the wood face smooth and any rough epoxy edges after demolding.
13	Wood conditioner / sanding sealer	Apply to the wood face before pouring epoxy to prevent air bubbles rising from the w
14	Hanging hardware	A sawtooth hanger or D-ring screwed to the back for wall mounting.
15	AA battery	For the quartz clock movement.

■ ***Wood sourcing tip:*** *Look for wood slices at sawmills, arborists (after tree removal), or online marketplaces. Always choose fully dried slices — moisture is the #1 enemy of clear epoxy.*

Step-by-Step Instructions

Step 1 — Prepare the Wood Slice

A dried wood slice with natural tree rings, live edge bark, and a central hole drilled for the clock shaft

Start with a fully dried wood slice — this is non-negotiable. Sand the face smooth, working through grits from 120 up to 400, then wipe clean with a tack cloth. If no central hole exists, find the exact centre using a ruler and drill a hole sized to your clock mechanism shaft (usually 8–10 mm).

- Sand in the direction of the grain — circular sanding scratches show under resin.
- Find the exact centre: draw two diameter lines across the wood at 90° to each other — their intersection is the centre.
- Drill the centre hole slowly with a sharp bit — support the wood from below to prevent splitting.
- Apply a thin coat of wood conditioner or sanding sealer to the face and let dry 1 hour — this seals the wood pores and prevents air bubbles in the resin.
- Lightly sand the bark edge with 80-grit to remove loose debris, but preserve its natural texture.

■ ***Crack tip:*** *Natural cracks in the wood are a design feature — they'll fill beautifully with coloured epoxy. Don't fill them before pouring — the resin does this automatically.*

Step 2 — Position Wood in the Silicone Mold

Placing the wood slice face-down into the larger circular silicone mold — the gap creates the resin border

Place the wood slice face-down in the centre of the silicone mold. The gap between the wood's live edge and the mold wall is where the dark epoxy border will form. Make sure the wood sits flat — tape or clay underneath can level any unevenness.

- Place wood face-down so the clock face surface sits against the clean mold bottom — this gives the smoothest finish.
- The gap around the wood should be 2–5 cm wide for a dramatic resin border.
- Seal any large gaps under the wood edges with hot glue or clay to prevent resin seeping underneath.
- Mark the 12 o'clock position on the back of the wood now — before pouring — using masking tape.
- Pre-position the brass hour marker rods around the border at the 12 clock positions, pressed into the mold wall.

■ ***Tip:*** *Place the mold on a perfectly level surface before pouring — use a spirit level and adjust with wedges if needed. Epoxy self-levels, so any tilt creates an uneven border.*

Step 3 — Mix & Tint the Epoxy Resin

Measure your epoxy resin and hardener precisely according to the manufacturer's ratio — usually 1:1 by volume. Combine in a mixing cup and stir slowly and thoroughly for 3–5 minutes, scraping the sides and bottom. Then add your black pigment or alcohol ink — a little goes a long way. Stir until fully incorporated and the colour is uniform.

- Always measure epoxy by volume (or weight per manufacturer spec) — wrong ratios cause sticky, soft, uncured resin.
- Stir slowly and deliberately — fast stirring creates bubbles.
- Scrape the sides and bottom of the cup throughout — unmixed resin stays liquid forever.
- For deep black: use black pigment paste or black alcohol ink — add gradually until you reach the desired opacity.
- For a more translucent smoke effect: use less pigment — the wood grain shows subtly through the resin border.
- Pour mixed resin within 20–30 minutes of mixing — before it starts to thicken.

■ ***Safety:*** *Always work in a well-ventilated area. Wear nitrile gloves and safety glasses throughout. Uncured epoxy is a skin and respiratory sensitiser.*

Step 4 — Pour the Epoxy

Pouring black-tinted epoxy resin over the wood slice and into the surrounding mold gap

The resin spreads and fills the border gap and the natural cracks in the wood

Pour the tinted epoxy slowly and steadily into the gap around the wood, working your way around the circumference. The resin will self-level and also flow into the natural cracks in the wood slice, filling them with glossy black. Pour until the resin is level with the top surface of the wood.

- Pour slowly in a thin stream — avoid splashing into the wood grain.
- Let the resin find its own level — don't rush to spread it with a tool.
- Watch for resin flowing into the cracks of the wood — this is normal and beautiful.
- If the wood floats up, press it back down gently and tape it in place until the resin firms.
- Within 5 minutes of pouring, pass a heat gun or torch quickly over the surface — this pops surface bubbles.
- Repeat the heat pass every 30 minutes for the first 2 hours.

■ ***Bubble tip:*** *Hold the heat gun 15–20 cm above the surface and move it continuously — never hold it still. 3–4 seconds per area is enough. Overheating can yellow or crack the resin.*

Step 5 — Cure for 24–48 Hours

Cover the mold with a cardboard box or plastic tent — keeping dust off is critical for a glass-smooth surface. Leave completely undisturbed for 24–48 hours at room temperature (20–25°C). The resin will feel firm to the touch after 24 hours but is not at full hardness for 7 days.

- Temperature matters: below 18°C, epoxy cures very slowly or not at all. Above 30°C, it may cure too fast and crack.
- Do not move, touch, or breathe on the surface during curing — even vibrations can create ripples.
- Check hourly for the first 3 hours for any leaks — epoxy can seep under the wood edge.
- After 24h, test hardness by pressing a fingernail into the resin edge — it should be fully hard.

> ■ ***Tip:*** *If you get a soft or tacky spot after 48 hours, the resin was incorrectly mixed. Sand the soft area away, re-mix carefully, and pour a thin top-up coat.*

Step 6 — Demold & Sand

After 48 hours, gently peel back the silicone mold. The clock face should release cleanly — the glossy side that was against the mold bottom becomes the front face. Sand any rough edges with 220-grit, then finish with 400-grit for a polished edge.

- Peel the mold back slowly from one side — don't pull straight up.
- The face (mold-side) will be glass-smooth; the back will be rougher — this is normal.
- Sand the resin edge with 220 then 400 grit — wet-sand for a better result.
- If any drips or runs exist on the edge, sand them flush and polish with plastic polish.
- Wipe the whole piece clean with a microfibre cloth dampened with isopropyl alcohol.

> ■ ***Tip:*** *For an ultra-clear, mirror-like edge finish, wet-sand through 400 → 800 → 1500 → 2000 grit, then buff with plastic polishing compound.*

Step 7 — Install the Clock Movement

Installing the quartz clock mechanism through the central hole — the brass shaft protrudes through the front

Insert the clock mechanism shaft through the centre hole from the back. The mechanism body sits against the back of the wood/resin piece. Thread the rubber washer, then the metal washer, then the nut onto the shaft from the front — tighten firmly by hand.

- The shaft must protrude at least 12–15 mm above the clock face for the hands to fit.
- If the shaft is too short for your wood thickness, use a clock mechanism with an 'extra long shaft' option.
- Tighten the front nut firmly but not with tools — over-tightening cracks the resin.
- Insert the battery and verify the mechanism is ticking before attaching hands.
- Set the time to 12:00 before attaching hands — makes alignment easier.

■ ***Tip:*** *For bedrooms, choose a 'silent sweep' quartz movement — no ticking sound. Standard movements tick once per second, which is audible in quiet rooms.*

Step 8 — Attach the Clock Hands

Attaching the gold hour and minute hands to the quartz clock mechanism shaft

Attach the clock hands in order: hour hand first, then minute hand, then second hand. Each presses onto a differently-sized fitting on the shaft. Set both hands to 12 o'clock, then press each one firmly straight down — they should click into place without force.

- Hour hand: shortest and widest — fits on the largest shaft fitting. Press straight down at 12.
- Minute hand: longest — fits on the medium shaft fitting. Press straight down at 12.
- Second hand: finest — presses onto the smallest pin at the very tip. Align at 12.
- Never bend the hands to fit — if they don't press on easily, the shaft size is wrong.
- Check that all hands rotate freely without touching each other or the clock face.

■ ***Tip:*** *Set the correct time, then hang the clock. Don't adjust the time by spinning the hands backward — always turn forward to avoid damaging the movement.*

The Finished Clock

The finished wood slice wall clock in warm morning light — a stunning piece of functional wall art

Pro Tips & Variations

★ Seal the wood before pouring	Brush a thin coat of the same epoxy (unmixed — just Part A) onto the wood face and let it soak in for 10 minutes before the main pour. This seals the wood pores and dramatically reduces bubbles rising into the resin.
★ Use different resin colours	Deep ocean blue creates a stunning water-and-wood effect. Translucent amber echoes the wood's warmth. Emerald green looks striking with pale birch. The resin colour defines the whole character of the clock.
★ Add metallic powder for shimmer	Mix a pinch of gold or bronze mica powder into the resin alongside the black pigment. In direct light, the border shimmers with metallic highlights — spectacular in combination with the gold hands.
★ Embed elements in the resin border	Place dried flowers, moss, or small crystals in the resin border before it cures. Position them with tweezers after the initial pour and let them settle. Encased botanical elements look extraordinary.
★ Choose the right wood species	Walnut: dark, dramatic grain that pairs perfectly with gold. Olive: wild swirling grain, exceptional character. Oak: bold rings with classic appeal. Maple: light, clean — works best with coloured resin borders.
★ Make a matching pair	Two clocks — one with black resin and gold hands, one with natural wood and silver hands — hung side by side create a gallery wall statement. Use slices from the same tree for a cohesive look.
★ Create the hour markers	Instead of buying brass rods, cut short pieces (4 cm) of 4 mm copper pipe, sand one end flat, and embed them in the wet resin at the 12 clock positions. Much cheaper and equally beautiful.
★ Selling price guidance	At craft markets and Etsy, clocks like this typically sell for $120–350 depending on wood species, resin quality, and size. Larger diameter (40 cm+) and exotic wood species command the highest prices.

Troubleshooting

✗ Problem: Resin is sticky / not curing after 48 hours

✓ **Solution:** Wrong mixing ratio or insufficient mixing. Uncured resin cannot be fixed — scrape it off, sand the surface, and re-pour with a correctly measured and mixed batch. Always measure both parts precisely and mix for the full 5 minutes.

✗ Problem: Bubbles on the resin surface

✓ **Solution:** Not enough heat gun passes, or the wood wasn't sealed first. Pass the heat gun or torch over the surface every 30 minutes for the first 2 hours. A sealed wood surface releases far fewer bubbles.

✗ Problem: Resin leaked under the wood slice

✓ **Solution:** The seal between wood edge and mold bottom was insufficient. Use hot glue or clay to seal the perimeter of the wood before pouring. If resin seeped under the face, sand it flush after curing.

✗ Problem: Resin yellowed after a few months

✓ **Solution:** Used a non-UV-stable epoxy. Always specify UV-resistant resin for items near windows. Existing yellowing can be partially corrected by wet-sanding and re-coating with UV-stable resin.

✗ Problem: Clock hands collide or don't move freely

✓ **Solution:** The hands are bent or the shaft fittings are wrong. Gently bend hands to create a 1–2 mm gap between each. If the mechanism shaft is too short, replace with a long-shaft version.

✗ Problem: Wood cracked further after pouring

✓ **Solution:** The wood had residual moisture. The cracks will be filled and held by the cured resin — this is not a structural problem. For future projects, dry wood thoroughly (ideally kiln-dried) and seal before pouring.

Thank you for your purchase!

Time passes differently when it's measured by something you built yourself. We hope every glance at your clock reminds you what hands can make.

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